Cancer treatment within 62 days

Forecast for September 2026 · data through August 2026

The latest Cancer treatment within 62 days result was 71.9%. For the next release, it is expected to worsen to 69.7%. The model's expected deterioration is mainly due to the usual month-to-month seasonal movement; the underlying trend is broadly flat. The current projection is off course for 80% by March 2027. Across providers, sustained favourable signals outnumber adverse ones (29 to 25).

LATEST · AUGUST 2026	FORECAST · SEPTEMBER 2026	ACTUAL
71.9%	**69.7%**	—
1.2pp above forecast	80% expected range 68.0%–71.1%	Not yet released
		Off course · 80% by March 2027

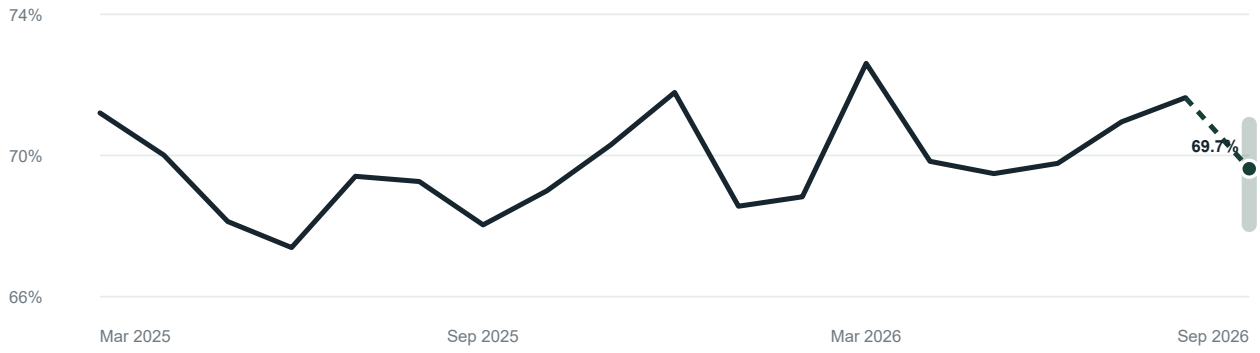
WHAT CHANGED?

Cancer treatment within 62 days improved in the latest month. Treatments in the published cohort changed by -3,610, while Treatments within 62 days changed by -2,362. The percentage therefore reflects both the size of the cohort and how many were within the standard.

Monthly	Annual	Treatments in the published cohort
+0.7pp	+2.6pp	-3,610

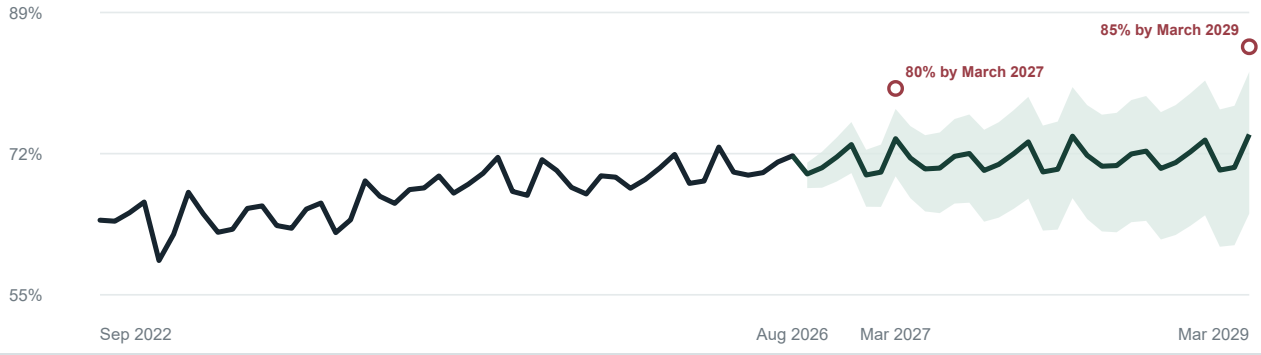
Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 85% constitutional standard. 6.0pp below milestone

Data: NHS England cancer waiting times. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework interim target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target

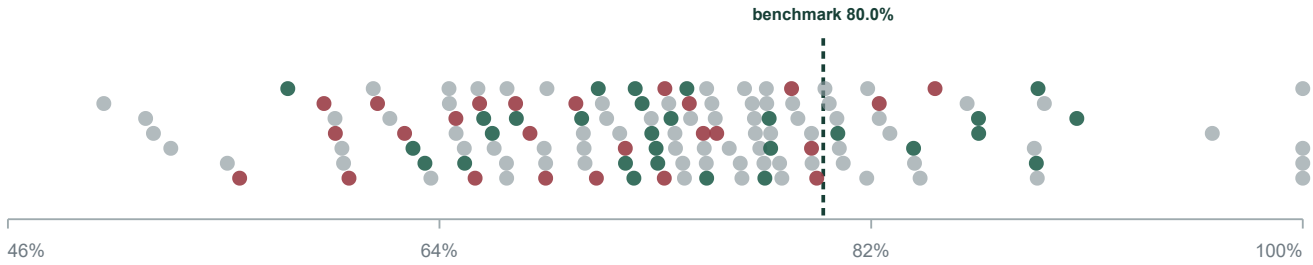
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 53 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 24 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 24 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

Cancer treatment within 62 days

Distribution and trajectory watch · August 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.

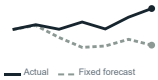


Trajectory watch

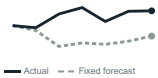
Six actual months are compared with one forecast path fixed before that window. Both lines begin at the same observed value. A low performer can be improving, while a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the average gap across those six months.

114	29	25	60
providers assessed	sustained favourable	sustained adverse	without an active signal

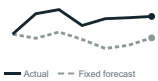
Largest sustained favourable moves

NORTH CUMBRIA INTEGRATED CARE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 77.8% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


14.6pp
BETTER THAN FIXED PATH

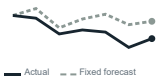
CHELSEA AND WESTMINSTER HOSPITAL NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 90.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


12.4pp
BETTER THAN FIXED PATH

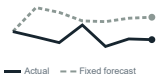
COUNTESS OF CHESTER HOSPITAL NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 83.8% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


9.4pp
BETTER THAN FIXED PATH

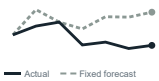
Largest sustained adverse moves

EAST CHESHIRE NHS TRUST
Latest 59.2% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


9.3pp
WORSE THAN FIXED PATH

SURREY AND SUSSEX HEALTHCARE NHS TRUST
Latest 69.7% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


9.1pp
WORSE THAN FIXED PATH

BEDFORDSHIRE HOSPITALS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 61.4% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


8.2pp
WORSE THAN FIXED PATH

Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.